been seen on closed-circuit television cameras, entering the building where the consulate was located.

Whether he had originally planned to stay in China or go to Russia, it seemed Snowden was working on a number of possibilities for asylum. Ecuador's Foreign Minister Ricardo Patiño told a reporter his government had received an asylum request from Snowden. Snowden received help on his asylum requests from Sarah Harrison, a representative of WikiLeaks. Accompanied by Harrison, Snowden boarded a Russian Aeroflot plane on June 23, 2013. His flight itinerary would take him first to Moscow, Russia, where he had a seat reserved on a plane to Cuba. From Havana, Cuba, he planned to fly to Caracas, Venezuela. From there he hoped to fly to Ecuador, where, if all went well, he would seek asylum and live as a free man. All would not go well.

WIKILEAKS

Australian Julian Assange founded WikiLeaks in 2007 as an online location for whistle-blowers to post secrets without having to go through traditional media outlets. It provides a highly encrypted drop box where people can anonymously post leaks, which are then reviewed by WikiLeaks volunteers. If deemed newsworthy and legitimate, the leak is posted on the site along with an analysis. The US government wanted to find Assange after he released the top-secret defense-related documents Chelsea Manning leaked in 2010.

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